STUDENTS RESULTS MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

System Documentation

Purpose

To streamline student academic records, continuous assessments, examinations, grading, class management, and reporting.

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Introduction

Welcome to the Student Results Management System (SRMS). This system is designed to streamline the process of managing academic data for primary and secondary schools. It allows administrators to manage subjects, classes, students, and teachers, while facilitating the efficient recording and computation of student results and generation of reports.

This manual will guide you through the installation process and explain the functionality of each module in detail.

System Requirements

Before installation, ensure your server meets the following minimum requirements:

- **Web Server:** Apache / Nginx / IIS
- **PHP Version:** 7.4 or higher (8.0+ recommended)
- **Database:** MySQL 5.7 or higher / MariaDB 10.3 or higher
- **PHP Extensions:**
    - PDO with MySQL driver
    - json
    - GD Extension
    - ZIP Extension
- **Web Browser:** Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, or Safari (latest versions)

Installation Guide

Follow these steps to deploy the SRMS on your server:

1. **Upload Files:** Upload all the system files from the provided package to your web server's root directory (e.g., public_html, www, or htdocs).
2. **Create Database:** Create a new MySQL database for the SRMS using your hosting control panel (e.g., cPanel) or a database management tool like phpMyAdmin.
3. **Configure Database Connection:**
    - Locate the configuration **.env**
    - Edit this file with your database details: DB_HOST (usually localhost), DB_PORT, DB_NAME, DB_USERNAME and DB_PASSWORD.
4. **Log In:** Use the provided administrator credentials (Email : **abel.msuya@srms.test**, Password **12345678**) to log in to the system via the main login page (e.g., www.yourschool.ac.tz/staff/login). Teachers and students can login using their full name as password for example a teacher or student named Bwire Mashauri his default password will be **BWIREMASHAURI**

Modules Overview

The SRMS is organized into logical modules accessible from the main navigation menu. The following section provides a detailed guide for each module.

Detailed Modules Guide

1. Subjects Module

This module allows you to define all subjects taught at your school.

- **Subject Code:** A unique, short identifier for the subject (e.g., MAT, ENG, KIS).
- **Subject Name:** The full name of the subject (e.g., Mathematics, English Language, Kiswahili).
- **Principal Subject:** A critical setting.
    - If marked as **"Yes"**, this subject will be included in the calculation of the student's total points and division/grade.
    - If marked as **"No"**, the subject will appear on the student's report card but will **not** be factored into the final grading. Use this for non-core subjects.
- **Status:** Set the subject to ACTIVE (default) or DISABLED.

Best Practice: Use consistent and clear subject codes. Carefully consider which subjects are "Principal" as this directly impacts final results.

2. Continuous Assessments Module

Define the various tests and assignments that make up a student's continuous assessment for a term.

- **Assessment Name:** The name of the assessment component (e.g., Mid-Term Exam, Homeworks, Class Quizzes, Project).
- **Status:** Set to ACTIVE to make it available for use.
- **Weight:** The maximum score or the "out of" mark for this component (e.g., if the Mid-Term Exam is marked out of 30, enter 30). The system will use this to calculate percentages and aggregate scores.

3. Academic Programmes Module

Define the different academic tracks or streams offered by your school (e.g., Science, Arts, Business, General Primary Education).

- **Programme Name:** Enter the name of the programme.
- **Assign Course Components:** This is a crucial step. Here, you link the programme to the specific **Subjects** (from Module 1) that a student enrolled in this programme is required to take.

4. Award Method Module

This module controls how student scores are converted into grades and divisions.

- **Grading System:** This is where you define the grade boundaries (e.g., A, B, C, etc.). The system comes pre-configured with a common Tanzanian grading scale, but you can update it.
    - *Example:* A: 81-100, B: 61-80, C: 41-60, etc.
- **Division System:** This defines the overall division boundaries based on the student's total points or average from principal subjects. The system is pre-configured with the common Tanzanian division system (Division I, II, III, IV, 0).
    - *Example:* Division I: 201-250 points, Division II: 151-200 points, etc.

Important: These systems are **not constant**. You can update the score ranges for grades and divisions at any time to reflect changes in national policy or school rules.

5. Academic Terms Module

Manage the academic calendar.

- **Term Name:** Enter a descriptive name for the term (e.g., Term I - 2024, Term II - 2024).
- **Academic Year:** Specify the academic year for this term.
- **Status:** Set as ACTIVE for the current term or CLOSED for past terms.

Note: The administrator must create new terms at the beginning of each new academic year. Results are always linked to a specific term.

6. Teachers Module

Add all teaching staff to the system.

- **Teacher Details:** Enter basic information like Name, Email, and Phone Number.
- **Assignment:** Teachers are assigned to specific subjects when a **Class** is created (see Module 7). A teacher can only view and enter results for the subjects they are assigned to.

7. Classes Module

Create and manage classes (or forms) within the school.

- **Class Name:** Enter the class name (e.g., Form 1A, Standard 5, Nursery B).
- **Academic Programme: This is a mandatory field.** You must assign an **Academic Programme** (from Module 3) to this class. This automatically defines the list of subjects that students in this class will be taking.

8. Students Module

Manage student records.

- **Add Student Individually:** You can manually add a student by filling in their details (Name, Admission Number, etc.) and assigning them to a **Class** (from Module 7).
- **Import Students (Bulk Upload):** For adding many students at once, use the import feature. Prepare an Excel/CSV file with columns for student details (e.g., admission_no, full_name, class_id). Use the provided template to ensure the correct format. After uploading, the system will assign all students to their respective classes.

9. Examination Results Module

This is the core module for recording student performance.

- **For Administrators:** Have full access to enter, edit, and view results for **all students, subjects, and classes**.
- **For Teachers:** Can only access the results entry page for **subjects and classes they have been assigned to** (as set in the Classes Module).
- **Process:** Select the **Term**, **Class**, and **Subject**. The system will display a list of students in that class. You can then enter scores for each Continuous Assessment component (e.g., enter a score out of 30 for the Mid-Term Exam). The system automatically calculates totals, percentages, and grades based on the defined Award Methods.

10. Announcements Module

Communicate effectively with staff and students.

- **Create Announcement:** Write a title and detailed message.
- **Select Audience:** Choose who can see the announcement:
    - **Teachers Only**
    - **Students Only**
    - **All Users** (Both Teachers and Students)
- The announcement will appear on the respective users' dashboards upon login.

11. System Settings

This central location allows the administrator to configure the entire system.

- **School Profile:** School Name, Address, Logo, Phone Number, etc.
- **Email Configurations:** SMTP settings (Server, Port, Username, Password) to enable the system to send emails (e.g., for password resets or announcements).
- **Report Signatures:** Upload or manage the digital signatures that will appear on official student report cards (e.g., Head Teacher's signature, Class Teacher's signature).

- **Other Properties:** Various system-wide settings can be managed here.

Data Management Best Practices

CRITICAL: AVOID DELETING DATA.

The SRMS database is relational, meaning all records are interconnected.

- **Deleting a record can have catastrophic, cascading effects.**
    - Example: If you **delete a Class**, the system will also automatically delete **all Students** in that class and **all Examination Results** associated with those students for that class. This data is **irrecoverable**.
- **The recommended and safe alternative is to change the STATUS of a record to** DISABLED**.**
    - If a subject is no longer offered, set its status to DISABLED. It will remain in the database for historical report integrity but will not appear in active selection lists.
    - If a teacher leaves, set their status to DISABLED. Their historical grade entries will be preserved.
    - At the end of an academic year, set the term's status to CLOSED. This archives the data without removing it.

By following this "soft delete" practice, you ensure the integrity and history of all academic records are maintained.